

SEPTEMBER 2020

EDUCATION

Enlighten and Empower

WHAT'S IN STORE FOR YOU

- A Hadith to reflect upon
- Student Feature Story
- This month's read

PEARLS OF WISDOM

Abu Huraira reported Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) as saying:

Whoever removes a worldly hardship from a believer, Allah will remove one of the hardships of the Day of Resurrection from him. Whoever conceals (the fault of) a Muslim in this world, Allah will conceal him (his faults) in this world and the Hereafter. Allah will help a person so long as he is helping his brother.

Reference Sahih Muslim 2699 a In-book reference : Book 48, Hadith 48
(The above Hdaith is a part of a longer Hadith)

OUR VISION

To uplift and transform the Muslim society from their educational poverty in the light of true knowledge which leads one back to Allah

ORGANIZATION'S UPDATE

*Alhumdulillah, up till now we have been able to assist 33 students in continuing their academic journey. In this month, a total of Rs. 53,910 has been collected and Rs. 1,27,470 has been spent on the educational needs of the beneficiaries. Along with financial support, we also provide mentorship to all the students for career and personal counselling. For more detailed information of all the cases **click** on the link shared at the end of this page.*

SCALING NEW HEIGHTS WITH ARSHAD

Arshad is a 2nd year BCA student from Lucknow. His father owns a Paan shop and has worked hard to put together enough money to send Arshad to a good English medium school. However, due to the university fees being high the family has struggled to make payments. Alhamdulillah, through the group's involvement Arshad has been able to make the fee payments and has additionally joined a personality development program.

THE RICH MAN AND HIS WILL

Story by Sheikh Waleed Basyouni

Riyadh is not only the capital of Saudi Arabia but a city of more than ten million residents, one of them passed away & left behind him a great wealth but no one to inherit. A judge in Riyadh's court was asked to look at this interesting inheritance case. The judge searched for any relatives for the wealthy businessman & he could not find any contact, & finally, after almost a year they were able to identify three distant cousins who lived in another city. Sure, enough the court contacted the three cousins & ordered them to attend the court without informing them the reason behind the request. They arrive at the judge's office & it was obvious that they were simple countrymen. They were wondering why they were summoned there but the judge quickly assured them that there was no reason for worry. Did they know so & so (the deceased wealthy businessman)? They said he was a distant relative, they knew nothing about him, & the last time they saw him was when they were young decades ago, & since their father passed away, they never heard about him.

Judge asked them if he has any children or if he was ever in a marriage that is not registered in the country or abroad or anything like that? They said we do not know, ask him?

The judge said he is dead; you do not know? They said "no, may Allah have mercy on him. What we know is that he lived by himself & never married, nor did he have any family members other than our father."

This answer comforted the judge & confirmed his conclusion that they are the only inheritors.

Finally, the judge took 3 envelopes out from his drawer & handed it to them while saying that the man's inheritance was in the court's bank account for almost a year now looking for the inheritors & you are the ones! They looked at each other wondering what these envelopes can deliver? Each one of them got 15 million Riyals, almost 4 million dollars!

They were in a state of shock. One of them fainted, the other one was crying & the third one was speechless & frizzed for a while when the judge confirmed the amount & stated that it is their money now and they should be grateful and thankful to Allah and pray for the man who worked hard to make this money. After a few minutes they calmed down and the judge asked if they would agree to put together funds to build a masjid on behalf of their relative since he did not leave behind any children or wrote a will for Sadaqah (giving charity), the judge suggested a project he knows of & it will cost them fractions of what he gave them.

The first one quickly replied, good idea but I have so many kids & debts. I will see what I can do later. The second person said while he is looking down at the ground "Your honour I would love too, but I have a big family as well & my kids are about to get married, Allah knows I needed money these days so badly but I will make sure I will give sadaqah on his behalf when I go back & remember him in my prayer. As for the third one, he said something the judge said, **"It was like a wake up call for me."** The third person said: "Your honour if he did not care to benefit himself why would I care! My family deserve this more than anyone else." The judge said long after they left:

"...if he did not care to benefit himself..". After this, the judge made sure to write in his own will that part of his wealth goes to a charity of his choice. This story shows the nature of men & the stunning truth about reality.

Reflections on this Story:

1. “....If he did not care to benefit himself..”

It is important to think about what will happen to you after your death & your deeds are stopped. And if some children or relatives will remember you after your death, please understand they will remember you for a month or a year for sure but not the next generation. Always ask yourself “How can I ensure good deeds through me to continue after my death?” and remember, with a small amount every month you can sponsor an orphan, or invest money in supporting a school. So its recommended that you leave something behind, that will continue generating reward for you after death. On the authority of Abu Hurairah (radiallaahu anhu) that the Messenger of Allah(sallallaahu alayhi wasallam) said,

‘When a person dies, his deeds come to an end except for three: Sadaqah Jariyah:(a continuous charity), or knowledge from which benefit is gained, or a righteous child who prays for him’. [Muslim]

2. Our lives can change from the outside in no time, but the important point here is, are we going to change from the inside. It is a pity if your income grew & you didn't. I wonder if these three men were financially well off, would they respond differently?! My guess is no. Giving is never about how much you have but is based on how much you care. That is why I advise you to get in the habit of giving now when you are young and do not have much income, because if you think you will when you get rich or when you get older, you are wishful and most likely it will not happen because if you live upon something most likely you will die upon it as well. And among them are those who made a covenant with Allah, [saying],

"If He should give us from His bounty, we will surely spend in charity, and we will surely be among the righteous." But when he gave them from His bounty, they were stingy with it and turned away while they refused.

{Surah At Tawbah 9: Verses 75-76}

3. Write your will, you do not know when your time will come, and how fast things can change. If you have debts, bank accounts information, charity to give, Islamic obligations such as Fasting or Fidyyah (penalty to be paid), Hajj to be done on your behalf, someone you need to ask for their forgiveness, and advice for your family to reflect upon after you die, or who should handle your funeral make sure all of these are there. The Muslim scholars recommended having your will written due to the hadeeth related by Ibn Omar (radiallaahu anhu) who said the Prophet (sallallaahu alayhi wasallam) said:

“It is not permissible for any Muslim person who has anything to bequeath, that he should spend even two nights without having already written his Last Will.” [Al-Bukhari & Muslim]

